

June 25, 2025

RE: Letter of Support for Dr Huong Thi-Thanh Ha – Sydney Vietnam Institute Seed Grant

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to express my full support for Dr Huong Thi-Thanh Ha's application for the Sydney Vietnam Institute Seed Grant.

My name is Dr Halle Quang, and I am a Postdoctoral Research Fellow at the Brain and Mind Centre, The University of Sydney. My research focuses on cross-cultural neuropsychology, dementia, traumatic brain injury, and neuroimaging. In particular, I investigate the neuropsychological outcomes of traumatic brain injury and dementia, with a focus on cognitive changes and apathy. I am also committed to advancing neuropsychological assessment for Vietnamese populations by validating and adapting culturally appropriate clinical tools.

Given my background in ageing and dementia research, I am pleased to support Dr Ha's proposed project to develop a speech-based protocol and database for the early detection of Alzheimer's disease and mild cognitive impairment. This initiative is especially timely and relevant in contexts where access to advanced neuroimaging is limited.

My previous work on the Vietnamese adaptation of the Montreal Cognitive Assessment (MoCA), along with ongoing collaborations with Vietnamese researchers, has underscored the importance of accessible, culturally sensitive diagnostic methods. I will contribute to this project through my expertise in neuropsychological assessment design, clinical interpretation, and the adaptation of tools to ensure both cultural relevance and clinical applicability.

Furthermore, I will offer guidance on methodology, validation strategies, and data interpretation, drawing on my experience in cross-cultural research and international collaborations.

Following in-depth discussions with Dr Ha, we strongly believe that this project will make a meaningful contribution to the early detection and management of neurodegenerative diseases, ultimately improving outcomes and quality of life for individuals affected by dementia.

Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require any further information.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Halle Quang', with a horizontal line underneath.

Dr Halle Quang
Postdoctoral Research Fellow
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The University of Sydney
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